



▲ The panel shares its view on how to migrate to FOSS development stack



▲ Audience in the IT Managers' track



▲ Panel shares information on software development languages and platforms



▲ An attendee clarifies his doubt



▲ Boudhayan shares his reasons for fiddling with FOSS

During one of our sessions in the developers' hall, just when the last speaker stood up to present his ideas, we had an audio goof up from the snippets of audio from the adjacent room streamed in with the announcement, "2 more minutes left". Oops!

addressed to the IT managers. The first session of this track was kick-started with the all-important question, "Why FOSS makes sense for your IT infrastructure?" The panelists for the session included Varad Gupta, head of Kean & Able, Dibya Prakash, technology manager at Azri Inc, Vivek Bhatnagar, country director and global alliances, Ingres Corporation, and Venkat Mangudi, CEO, Venkat Mangudi Consulting.

The session touched upon various aspects of IT infrastructure within an organisation. While Mangudi spoke about the typical IT infrastructure set-up in any firm, Gupta built a case of how, why and when to go for open source solutions. Dibya Prakash also covered the details on why any organisation needs open source. Bhatnagar shared with the audience the critical role database solutions play, and how open source solutions excel over their proprietary rivals. The session seemed to further bolster the audience's confidence in open source.

The session was followed by a panel discussion on enterprise applications. It was chaired by Mangudi, while the other panelists comprised Abhijit Das, director, Konsults, D. Seetharam, government programs executive, IBM, Tim Cloonan, community manager, JasperSoft and Redhuan D. Oon, leader ADempire (ERP) Project. The panelists shared with the audience the various solutions available and how they address different needs. Cloonan also pointed out the way people get attached to the community and thus help improve the product.

The third session of the day was another panel discussion on messaging and communication systems. This was moderated by Varad Gupta, and the panelists included Vikash Jha, project manager (Open Source) at HSBC Investsmart, and D. Seetharam.

Post lunch, 'network monitoring and management' was the topic for discussion. The session was moderated by B.C. Sekar, senior project manager, networking products division, HCL, and the panelists included Vikash Jha and Satyakaam Goswami, a freelance FOSS consultant. It was structured to be more like a Q&A session, where the audience threw questions to the panel. These doubts

We had a guest who wanted to showcase KDE 4.2 to the audience. While using one of our compere's laptops, he mistakenly deactivated 3 of his notes that he had on another Activity. Poor guy had to keep remembering his to-do list all night long.

raised from the right kind of solution, to security in the network monitoring space. And the panelists gamely handled every question, putting to rest potential users' worries and misconceptions.

A double-edged discussion on security was the highlight of the evening's programme. PK. Mishra, principal consulting architect, Novell, represented the AppArmour side of the story, whereas Varad Gupta spoke up for SELinux. There was an interesting comparison between the two by supporters of the respective technologies.

The audience aired their concerns over certain open source solutions already deployed in their firms, as well as the problems they were facing with their current proprietary software-based infrastructure. While the panelists addressed these queries, they pretty much made it clear why open source is the way to go for an enterprise.

Day 2 Show 1: FOSS For Mobiles

Calling the response to these sessions a tsunami, would be an understatement! On the second day of the event, we were faced with a deluge of students, FOSS enthusiasts and IT managers. The hall hosting the IT Manager Track, dubbed as the *CXOSummit on Virtualisation*, was a full house, and we faced a situation where the rapt audience spilled on to the corridors in order to participate.

The situation at the Developers' Track was even worse, or should we say, better? The good news was that the hall with a capacity to seat 700 people was full. The bad news was that we had 500 more people to accommodate. The show was: *FOSS on Mobiles*. The actors were: Moblin, Android and OpenMoko. We were really elated at the success of the show, but we were completely at our wit's end on how to accommodate the 500 extra people. But did they mind? Nah, they were much